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POSITIVE OUTCOME OF IOC MISSION TO PAKISTAN

NOWSHERA, KHYBER PAKHTUNKHWA, PAKISTAN / 27.10.2021



On the last day of his mission to Pakistan, the Executive Director visited a large private olive grove in Nowshera, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Province, a two-hour drive from Islamabad.

The delegation and Pak Olive officials were welcomed by the owner of the property. While visiting an organic cultivation plot, they noted how healthy the trees were and that there were no diseases or pests. Both the fruit and the leaves were in good condition; they are used to prepare infusions and olive leaf tea. The Executive Director gave advice on pruning, grafting and irrigating the orchard.

The mission to Pakistan had three main objectives: to witness the implementation of the Pakistani plan to develop the olive sector; to monitor the implementation of IOC standards; and to confirm the willingness of the Pakistani authorities to join the IOC. At the end of this mission, it would be amiss not to express the delegation's appreciation to H.E. the Federal Minister for Food Security and Research of Pakistan, who, despite his ill health, insisted on welcoming the Executive Director at his home. Our sincere thanks also go to Dr Khair Muhammed Kakar, who spared no effort to assist the delegation and stayed with them throughout the mission, and to Dr Tariq Atatürk and Dr Azmet Ali Awan, who also accompanied the delegation on all its visits and took care of the logistics.

In the evening, the Executive Director took part in an unscheduled meeting with Ms Emanuela Benini, Director of the Italian Agency for Development and Cooperation (AICS). The Executive Director explained to her the overall mission of the IOC and the purpose of her visit to Pakistan. Ms Benini informed him of the work she was doing in Pakistan. She explained that the focus of her mission was on training, especially for research centres, and that in the field of olive cultivation, her work was related to the whole value chain of the olive sector. She also referred to a project being developed with CIHAEM in Bari to provide further support and assistance to the Pakistani authorities in this area. The Executive Director welcomed this initiative and expressed his wish to see the IOC as a partner in this project. He pledged to explore ways and means to partner in this endeavour, in accordance with the procedures, and to assist the government of Pakistan in the success of its olive development plan.

